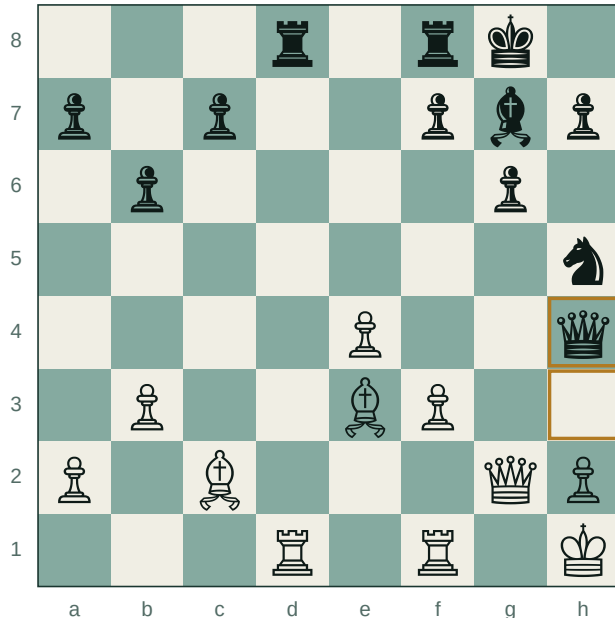


Forks and double attacks: White, move 24

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 23...Qh4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. Bg5 Ng3+ 25. Qxg3

24.Bg5 The bishop moves from e3 to g5. From g5 it attacks queen on h4 and rook on d8. Recorded reply: **24...Ng3+**.

25.Qxg3 The queen captures the knight on g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 30 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on h4. Check for tactical protection.